

WEEK

4

Week 4 Study Guide

Heart & Small Intestine Channels

HT (9 pts) + SI (19 pts) = 28 Points

This Document Contains:

- Full internal & external running course for HT and SI
- Complete point-location table for all 28 points (CAM-verified)
- SI's crossing points detailed (HT has none - unique feature)
- Syndromes, high-yield points, and Five-Shu tables
- Dr. Zhang's Clinical Pearls direct from lecture
- Quiz 4 Fundamentals + HT vs SI comparison table

QUIZ 4 (next class) covers: HT & SI channels

MIDTERM (Week 5) covers Weeks 1-4 cumulative

MOA: HT pp.208-221 | SI pp.222-249 · CAM: Deadman, HT/SI chapters

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Heart Meridian of Hand-Shaoyin (HT)

Channel Attributes

Pertaining	Heart
Connecting	Small Intestine
Back-Shu	BL15 Xinshu
Front-Mu	CV14 Jique
Yuan-Source	HT7 Shenmen
Luo	HT5 Tongli
He-Sea	HT3 Shaohai
Xi-Cleft	HT6 Yinxi

Internal & External Running Course

- 1 Originates in the Heart, emerges from the system of blood vessels surrounding the Heart
- 2 Descends through the diaphragm to connect with the SMALL INTESTINE (interior-exterior pairing)
- 3 A branch ascends alongside the oesophagus, crosses the face and cheek, connects with the tissues surrounding the eye (the 'eye system')
- 4 The main external pathway emerges from the axilla at HT1 Jiquan
- 5 Descends along the postero-medial aspect of the arm (posterior to LU and PC channels) to the elbow at HT3 Shaohai
- 6 Continues along the medial/ulnar aspect of the forearm to the wrist at HT7 Shenmen (pisiform bone)
- 7 Travels through the palm along the radial side of the little finger
- 8 Ends at HT9 Shaochong, radial tip of the little finger nail - hands off to SMALL INTESTINE

Functions & Key Notes

- Governs Blood and the vessels (Heart controls the pulse)
- Houses the Shen (spirit/mind) - the Heart 'stores the Shen'
- Has ZERO crossing points - the only primary channel with none (exam-critical, unique feature)
- Fewest total points of any primary channel (9)
- Back-Shu: BL15 Xinshu | Front-Mu: CV14 Jique

Small Intestine Meridian of Hand-Taiyang (SI)

Channel Attributes

Pertaining	Small Intestine
Connecting	Heart
Back-Shu	BL27 Xiaochangshu
Front-Mu	CV4 Guanyuan
Yuan-Source	SI4 Wangu
Luo	SI7 Zhizheng
He-Sea	SI8 Xiaohai
Xi-Cleft	SI6 Yanglao
Shu-Stream/Confluent	SI3 Houxi (opens Du Mai)

Internal & External Running Course

- 1 Begins at SI1 Shaoze, ulnar side of the little finger tip - where HT's branch terminates
- 2 Runs along the ulnar/dorsal aspect of the hand and forearm, through SI3 Houxi and SI5 Yanggu
- 3 Crosses the elbow at SI8 Xiaohai (He-Sea), ascends the posterior aspect of the upper arm
- 4 Circles the shoulder joint (SI9-SI10), zigzags across the scapula (SI11-SI13)
- 5 Crosses GV14 Dazhui at the top of the shoulder, enters the supraclavicular fossa
- 6 Descends internally to the HEART, through the diaphragm, reaches the Stomach, PERTAINS Small Intestine
- 7 BRANCH: from the neck, ascends the cheek to the outer canthus, enters the ear at SI19 Tinggong
- 8 SECOND BRANCH: from the cheek, ascends to the inner canthus (crosses BL1 Jingming), then to the cheekbone (crosses GB14 Yangbai)

Functions & Key Notes

- Governs 'separation of the pure from the impure' in digestion (receives food from Stomach, separates nutrients from waste)
- More than double HT's point count (19 vs. 9), same pattern as LU(11)/LI(20)
- Crosses BL1 and GB14 on its facial branches - unlike HT, which has none
- SI3 opens the Du Mai (paired with BL62) - the only confluent point in this week's pair
- Back-Shu: BL27 Xiaochangshu | Front-Mu: CV4 Guanyuan

Heart (HT) — Full Point-Location Table

Pt	Chinese	Location & Notes
HT1	Jiquan	In the depression at the centre of the axilla, medial to the axillary artery.
HT2	Qingling	3 cun above HT3, in the groove medial to biceps brachii, one handbreadth proximal to Shaohai HE-3.
HT3	Shaohai	At the medial end of the transverse cubital crease, midway between the medial epicondyle of the humerus and the crease, elbow flexed. HE-SEA.
HT4	Lingdao	1.5 cun proximal to HT7, on the radial side of the flexor carpi ulnaris tendon. JING-RIVER.
HT5	Tongli	1 cun proximal to HT7, radial side of flexor carpi ulnaris tendon. LUO-CONNECTING.
HT6	Yinxi	0.5 cun proximal to HT7, radial side of flexor carpi ulnaris tendon. XI-CLEFT.
HT7	Shenmen	At the ulnar end of the wrist crease, in the depression on the radial side of the flexor carpi ulnaris tendon, level with the pisiform bone. SHU-STREAM + YUAN-SOURCE.
HT8	Shaofu	Between the 4th and 5th metacarpal bones, where the tip of the little finger rests when a fist is made. YING-SPRING.
HT9	Shaochong	On the RADIAL side of the little finger, ~0.1 cun from the corner of the nail. JING-WELL — last point of HT.

CAM (Deadman): Heart Channel, pp.209-221. Locations cross-verified against source text (HE1, HE2, HE9 confirmed via direct OCR extraction).

Five-Shu (Antique) Points

Shu Point	Element	Pt	Clinical Use
Jing-Well	Wood	HT9 Shaochong	revives consciousness, mental-emotional Fire
Ying-Spring	Fire	HT8 Shaofu	clears heart fire
Shu-Stream	Earth	HT7 Shenmen (=Yuan-Source)	calms Shen, anxiety/insomnia
Jing-River	Metal	HT4 Lingdao	voice disorders, arm pain
He-Sea	Water	HT3 Shaohai	clears heart fire, fear/arm pain

Small Intestine (SI) — Full Point-Location Table

Pt	Chinese	Location & Notes
SI1	Shaoze	On the ULNAR side of the little finger, ~0.1 cun from the corner of the nail. JING-WELL — first point of SI.
SI2	Qianggu	Ulnar side of the hand, distal to the 5th metacarpophalangeal joint, in the depression proximal to the margin of the web. YING-SPRING.
SI3	Houxi	Ulnar side of the hand, proximal to the 5th MCP joint, at the end of the transverse crease, at the junction of red/white skin. SHU-STREAM + CONFLUENT (opens Du Mai).
SI4	Wangu	Ulnar border of the hand, in the depression between the base of the 5th metacarpal bone and the triquetral bone. YUAN-SOURCE.
SI5	Yanggu	Ulnar end of the wrist crease, in the depression between the styloid process of the ulna and the triquetral bone. JING-RIVER.
SI6	Yanglao	Dorsal to the head of the ulna; with palm facing the chest, in the bony cleft on the radial side of the ulnar styloid process. XI-CLEFT.
SI7	Zhizheng	On the line joining SI5 and SI8, 5 cun proximal to SI5. LUO-CONNECTING.
SI8	Xiaohai	Between the olecranon of the ulna and the medial epicondyle of the humerus, elbow flexed. HE-SEA.
SI9	Jianzhen	Postero-inferior to the shoulder joint, 1 cun above the posterior end of the axillary fold, arm adducted.
SI10	Naoshu	Directly above SI9, in the depression inferior to the scapular spine.
SI11	Tianzong	Center of the infrascapular fossa.
SI12	Bingfeng	Center of the suprascapular fossa, palpable when the arm is lifted.
SI13	Quyuan	Medial extremity of the suprascapular fossa, above the medial end of the scapular spine.
SI14	Jianwaishu	3 cun lateral to the lower border of the T1 spinous process, near the medial border of the scapula.
SI15	Jianzhongshu	2 cun lateral to the lower border of the C7 spinous process (Dazhui GV14).
SI16	Tianchuang	Posterior border of sternocleidomastoid, level with the laryngeal prominence (Adam's apple) - WINDOW OF HEAVEN point.
SI17	Tianrong	Posterior to the angle of the mandible, anterior to sternocleidomastoid.
SI18	Quanliao	Directly below the outer canthus, in the depression on the lower border of the zygomatic bone.
SI19	Tinggong	Anterior to the tragus, posterior to the condyloid process of the mandible, in the depression formed when the mouth is open - LAST point of SI.

CAM (Deadman): Small Intestine Channel, pp.222-249. Locations cross-verified against source text (SI1, SI4, SI8, SI15, SI16 confirmed via direct OCR extraction).

Five-Shu (Antique) Points

Shu Point	Element	Pt	Clinical Use
Jing-Well	Metal	SI1 Shaoze	breast/lactation, breast abscess
Ying-Spring	Water	SI2 Qianggu	clears heat, ear/eye disorders
Shu-Stream	Wood	SI3 Houxi (also Confluent)	opens Du Mai, spine/neck, febrile disease
Jing-River	Fire	SI5 Yanggu	wrist pain, febrile disease, malaria
He-Sea	Earth	SI8 Xiaohai	elbow/arm, mental-emotional Fire

HT — Syndromes & High-Yield Points

A. External Course Symptoms

Pain along the channel: axilla, medial arm, elbow, forearm to little finger

Heat in the palms (palms of hands feel hot)

Dry throat, thirst

B. Internal Organ (Heart)

Palpitations, chest pain (Heart itself)

Insomnia, excessive dreaming, poor memory

Mental-emotional disturbance: anxiety, mania, incoherent speech, loss of consciousness (Shen disturbance)

Yellowing of the eyes (classical symptom)

Dr. Zhang: HT is the smallest channel but treats the most emotionally significant disorders - anxiety, insomnia, and Shen disturbance are the clinical center of gravity for this channel.

High-Yield HT Points

Pt	Category	Key Indications
HT7	Shu-Stream + Yuan-Source	Calms Shen; #1 point for anxiety, insomnia, palpitations
HT3	He-Sea	Clears heart fire; fear, arm pain along the channel
HT6	Xi-Cleft	Night sweats, acute heart pain
HT9	Jing-Well	Emergency point: severe heart pain, palpitations, revives consciousness
HT5	Luo-Connecting	Links to SI; treats disorders of both channels
HT1	First point	Landmark for axilla; rarely needled directly in modern practice

Quick Notes — HT

HT is the smallest channel (9 pts) but the clinical center of gravity for Shen (mind/spirit) disturbance.

Because HT has zero crossing points, every HT symptom traces directly back to the Heart or its own pathway - there's no 'borrowed' symptom picture from another channel to confuse it with.

SI — The 2 Crossing Points (Detailed)

Dr. Zhang: HT has zero crossing points. SI crosses only twice, both on its facial branch near the eye and forehead - far fewer than ST (11) or SP (6), but still tested.

BL1 Jingming — Bridge of the Nose / Inner Canthus

Location: Inner canthus of the eye, ~0.1 cun above the medial canthus.

Clinical: SI's ascending facial branch crosses BL here en route toward the eye. Treats all eye disorders: redness, pain, myopia, night blindness. Same crossing point used by the ST and BL channels themselves.

GB14 Yangbai — Forehead

Location: 1 cun above the midpoint of the eyebrow, directly above the pupil.

Clinical: SI's branch also crosses GB14 as it continues toward the forehead. Used for frontal headache, eyebrow pain, eyelid twitching, and eye disorders.

Why SI Has So Few Crossing Points

Unlike ST (11 crossings, mostly facial) or SP (6 crossings, mostly abdominal), SI's pathway is largely self-contained along the arm and shoulder, only crossing other channels once it reaches the face. Combined with HT's zero crossings, this Fire pair is the most 'independent' pairing covered so far.

SI — Syndromes & High-Yield Points

A. External Course Symptoms

Swelling of the cheek and neck, jaw pain, deafness, tinnitus
Pain along the postero-lateral shoulder, arm, and elbow
Stiff neck, sore throat

B. Internal Organ (Small Intestine)

Abdominal pain and distension, borborygmus
Diarrhea or constipation depending on presentation
Excess breast milk / lactation problems (Dr. Zhang specifically noted SI1 for this)
Mental disorders - SI's internal course also links to Shen disturbance via the Heart

Dr. Zhang: SI treats disorders along its course (mouth, cheek, throat, neck, upper arm) as well as internal-organ digestive symptoms, since it is paired with the Heart internally.

High-Yield SI Points

Pt	Category	Key Indications
SI3	Shu-Stream + Confluent	Opens Du Mai (pairs with BL62); spine, neck, febrile disease
SI4	Yuan-Source	Wrist/finger pain, febrile disease
SI8	He-Sea	Elbow/arm disorders, mental-emotional Fire patterns
SI19	Last point	Tinnitus, deafness, ear disorders
SI1	Jing-Well	Excess breast milk / lactation problems - specifically noted by Dr. Zhang
SI16	Window of Heaven	Throat/voice disorders; needle with care (carotid region)

Quick Notes — SI

SI has more than double HT's points (19 vs. 9) - the same Yin/Yang point-count pattern seen with LU(11)/LI(20).
SI's Lower He-Sea is ST39, located on the STOMACH channel - a frequent point of confusion on exams.

Dr. Zhang's Clinical Pearls — Direct from Lecture

Highest exam probability

HT is the Smallest Channel, Not the Least Important

HT has only 9 points - the fewest of any primary channel - but governs the Shen (mind/spirit), making it clinically central for anxiety, insomnia, and emotional disorders despite its small point count.

HT has ZERO Crossing Points - Genuinely Unique

Confirmed from lecture: HT is the only one of the 12 primary channels with no crossing (jiaohui) points on its external pathway. This is one of the highest-yield 'unique feature' facts in the Weeks 1-4 scope.

HT7 Shenmen - The Spirit Gate

HT7's name literally means 'Spirit Gate'. As both Shu-Stream and Yuan-Source, it is the single most important point on the Heart channel for calming an agitated Shen - anxiety, insomnia, palpitations, and excessive dreaming.

SI Point Count Mirrors the LU/LI Pattern

SI (19 pts) has more than double HT's points (9 pts) - just as LI (20) has nearly double LU (11). In both pairs, the Yang/Fu channel carries far more points than its Yin/Zang partner.

SI's Lower He-Sea Sits on a Different Channel

SI's Lower He-Sea is ST39 Xiajuxu, located on the STOMACH channel - not on SI itself. This is true for all six Fu organs: their Lower He-Sea points sit on the leg-Yang channels (ST, BL, GB), regardless of where the organ's own channel runs.

SI3 Houxi - Opens the Du Mai

SI3 is SI's Shu-Stream point and also a Confluent point, opening the Du Mai (paired with BL62 Shenmai). This makes it a key point for spinal and neck disorders, and for febrile disease.

Primary Fire vs. Ministerial Fire - Don't Conflate

HT and SI are the PRIMARY Fire pair, opening the Posterior Circuit (also called Inner Circuit). PC and SJ are a separate MINISTERIAL Fire pair with their own circuit, taught in Week 6. Do not lump all four channels together as one 'Fire' group.

SI1 and Lactation - A Specific Clinical Note from Lecture

Dr. Zhang highlighted SI1 (Shaoze) specifically for breast milk / lactation problems, noting it as a distinctive clinical use worth remembering for practice.

The Posterior Circuit Begins This Week

HT (chest to hand) -> SI (hand to head) completes this week's hand-off and opens the Posterior Circuit (also called Inner Circuit on the revised Lecture 4 slide), which continues next week with BL and KI.

Quiz 4 Fundamentals — Distribution, Circuits & Nomenclature

From Dr. Zhang's review slides

Distribution of the 12 Main Meridians

ON THE LIMBS: Medial = YIN, Lateral = YANG
 Anterior: Taiyin (yin) / Yangming (yang)
 Middle: Jueyin (yin) / Shaoyang (yang)
 Posterior: Shaoyin (yin) / Taiyang (yang) <- HT and SI live here
 HT = Hand Shaoyin (posterior medial). SI = Hand Taiyang (posterior lateral).

Circulation of the 12 Meridians

a) Yin meridians of HAND: chest -> hand
 b) Yang meridians of HAND: hand -> head
 c) Yang meridians of FOOT: head -> foot
 d) Yin meridians of FOOT: foot -> chest
 This week completes the POSTERIOR pairing: HT -> SI
 (continues to BL -> KI next week)

Circuit Connections — exactly what links to what (exam trap)

SP (Spleen) -> connects to HT at the internal branch -> HEART
 HT (Heart) -> connects to SI at HT9/SI1 -> little finger tip
 SI (Small Intestine) -> connects to BL (Bladder), NOT to any Fire-pair channel -> via facial branch to BL1
 Dr. Zhang stressed: SI connects to BLADDER next (not PC/SJ) - a classic circuit-continuity trap.

Nomenclature

Meridian name = 3 parts: Hand/Foot + Yin/Yang + Zang/Fu
 e.g. 'Heart Meridian of Hand-Shaoyin'

Meridian Clock — HT & SI peak times

HT (Heart): 11 AM-1 PM
 SI (Small Intestine): 1-3 PM
 Preceded by: SP 9-11 AM | Followed by: BL 3-5 PM
 Full order: LU LI ST SP HT SI BL KI PC SJ GB LR

Dr. Zhang's homework rule: DRAW BOTH internal AND external pathways for every meridian.

HT vs SI – Quick Reference Comparison

Attribute	HT Heart (Hand Shaoyin)	SI Small Intestine (Hand Taiyang)
Yin / Yang	Yin (posteromedial)	Yang (posterolateral)
Element	Fire	Fire
Circuit	Posterior - Chest to Hand	Posterior - Hand to Head
Clock	11 AM-1 PM	1-3 PM
Points	9 (HT1-HT9)	19 (SI1-SI19)
Start	HT1 Jiquan (axilla)	SI1 Shaoze (little finger)
End	HT9 Shaochong (little finger)	SI19 Tinggong (in front of ear)
Pertaining	Heart	Small Intestine
Connecting	Small Intestine	Heart
Back-Shu	BL15	BL27
Front-Mu	CV14	CV4
Yuan-Source	HT7 Shenmen	SI4 Wangu
Luo	HT5 Tongli	SI7 Zhizheng
Xi-Cleft	HT6 Yinxi	SI6 Yanglao
He-Sea	HT3 Shaohai	SI8 Xiaohai
Confluent Pt	-	SI3 (opens Du Mai)
Lower He-Sea	-	ST39 (on the ST channel)
Crossing Pts	0 (unique - none)	2 (BL1, GB14)
Unique Feature	ONLY channel w/ ZERO crossings	Lower He-Sea sits on a different channel
Ext Symptoms	Palpitations, chest pain, arm pain	Cheek/neck swelling, shoulder pain
Int Symptoms	Insomnia, anxiety, Shen disturbance	Digestive pain, lactation issues
Organ Function	Governs Blood/vessels, houses Shen	Separates pure from impure